

August 2026

Dear Srinivasan,

I've worked in and around the Lamorinda and Diablo Valley markets long enough to know when a renovation is done right, and the work at 2660 Ross Place is genuinely impressive. A full gut of electrical, plumbing, HVAC, and finishes on a 1950s West Walnut Creek home is a serious undertaking, and the result here is the kind of move-in-ready product that buyers in this price range are actively hunting for. So when I saw the listing come off market after just 28 days without a sale, it caught my attention.

Twenty-eight days is short enough that it doesn't carry the stigma of a long-stale listing, but on a fully renovated home priced at \$874 per square foot, a clean exit should have happened faster. At that price point, buyers are comparing carefully, and they need more than a description that lists amenities. They need to understand exactly what distinguishes this renovation from the dozens of 'fully updated' homes they've already scrolled past. The listing had the features. It just didn't build the case for them.

I've put together a short analysis of what I think created friction in the first campaign and what a relaunch strategy would need to look like for a home like this. It's specific to 2660 Ross Place, not a generic playbook.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside. If you're not, I'd genuinely enjoy a conversation about what a second approach might look like. No pressure either way.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read 'Ben Olsen', with a stylized flourish extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

2660 Ross Place

WALNUT CREEK, CA 94597

4.0 Beds · 3 Baths · 1,601 Sq Ft · WALNUT CREEK

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 2660 Ross Place

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Fully Gut-Renovated West Walnut Creek Home - and a Listing That Never Built the Case for It

2660 Ross Place is the kind of product Walnut Creek buyers at this price point say they want: new electrical, new plumbing, new HVAC, dual pane windows, a wide-open floor plan, a gourmet kitchen with shaker cabinetry and a central island, and two primary suites on a 10,372-square-foot lot in a walkable West Walnut Creek neighborhood. This isn't a cosmetic update. It's a complete rebuild of the systems and surfaces that matter most to buyers who've been burned by deferred maintenance before.

And yet the home came off market at 28 days without a sale. At \$874 per square foot, this property sits at the upper range of the Walnut Creek premium tier, which is supportable given the scope of the renovation. But supportable on paper and felt by buyers during a search are two different things. The listing description leaned heavily on adjectives like 'opulent,' 'lavish,' and 'exquisite,' while saying almost nothing specific about what the renovation actually involved or why this home is built differently than a surface-refresh competitor. Buyers comparing carefully at this price point needed a more grounded, specific narrative, and a distribution strategy that put that narrative in front of the right audience.

\$1,399,999

List Price

\$874/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch needs to do one thing above all: translate the real scope of this renovation into buyer confidence at \$874 per square foot. Every tool in the campaign should be working toward that single goal.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: The Renovation Was Real - The Marketing Description Wasn't

The listing description for 2660 Ross Place read more like a luxury hotel brochure than a credible account of what this home actually is. Phrases like 'opulent bathrooms,' 'lavish,' and 'mimic a spa-like experience' are the kind of language that triggers buyer skepticism rather than buyer confidence, especially at \$1,399,999 where people are reading carefully. The real story here is a complete systems overhaul on a 1956 home, new everything from panel to pipes to HVAC, and a floor plan that actually works for modern living. That story was never told. Buyers scrolling past generic luxury language never had a reason to slow down.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork listing remarks are written the way a great buyer's agent describes a home to a client, specific, credible, and built to earn trust. On Zillow Showcase, that narrative gets premium placement and is one of the first things a buyer reads, not buried in a scrolled-past description field.

Friction #2: \$874 Per Square Foot With Nothing to Show for It Visually

At \$874 per square foot, a buyer comparing this home against a \$750-per-square-foot alternative in the same city needs to see the difference, not just read about it. A fully gut-renovated 1956 home has visual proof baked into every room: new structural systems, clean finishes, open-concept flow, spa-caliber bathrooms. But standard MLS photography captures static angles, flat lighting, and front-elevation shots that don't communicate scope. Buyers who never toured the home, which is most of them, had no way to understand what \$874 per square foot actually got them here versus somewhere else.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

A 3D Matterport tour lets buyers walk every room on their own schedule, from San Francisco, from Oakland, from wherever they're searching, before they ever commit to a showing. For a renovation of this depth, that immersive walkthrough isn't a nice-to-have. It's the proof buyers need to justify the number.

Friction #3: A Move-In-Ready Home That the Right Buyers Never Found

West Walnut Creek at \$1.4 million is not a casual local search. The buyers most likely to pay a premium for a fully renovated, no-deferred-maintenance home in this neighborhood are professionals relocating from San Francisco or Oakland, buyers who've been renting while rates were high and are now ready to move decisively into something they don't have to touch. Those buyers were not browsing the Walnut Creek MLS waiting for this listing to appear. They needed to be reached where they were actively researching Lamorinda and Diablo Valley before they'd found a specific address. A passive MLS presence doesn't do that.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork runs geo-targeted digital campaigns aimed at SF and East Bay buyers who are researching this corridor but haven't yet committed to a neighborhood, putting this home in front of decision-ready buyers before they've found a competing listing.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	2660 Ross Place	Walnut Creek Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$874/sqft	Premium tier: \$820–\$950/sqft
Lot / Setting	10,372 sq ft lot, West Walnut Creek neighborhood	Typical Walnut Creek lot: 6,500–9,000 sq ft
Architectural Character	1956 ranch, fully gut-renovated with open-concept floor plan	Mix of vintage and partially updated mid-century inventory
Premium Features	New electrical, plumbing, HVAC, dual pane windows, two primary suites, gourmet kitchen with island	Standard floor plan, partial updates common at this price tier
HOA	None	None typical for single-family in this area

The verdict: At \$874/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$820-\$950/sqft, this home sits in the middle of that range. At \$874 per square foot, 2660 Ross Place sits near the middle of Walnut Creek's premium renovation tier, and the scope of work here genuinely supports that positioning. The gap isn't in the numbers. It's that the marketing never gave buyers the specific, credible evidence they needed to feel confident meeting the price. A relaunch built around visual proof and a grounded renovation narrative would put this home in a much stronger position.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Tell the Renovation Story in Buyer Language

New electrical panel, new plumbing, new HVAC, new windows, new flooring, new kitchen, new bathrooms. That's not a cosmetic refresh. That's a home rebuilt from the inside out, and buyers at \$1.4 million need to feel the weight of that before they schedule a showing. The relaunch campaign starts with a complete rewrite of the listing narrative, specific, grounded, and credible, paired with a Zillow Showcase placement that puts that story front and center on the platform where most buyers begin.

Pillar II - Give Buyers Visual Proof That Earns the Price

At \$874 per square foot, buyers are doing a mental comparison against every other option in their search. The two primary suites, the open-concept kitchen and living flow, the quality of the bathroom finishes, and the scale of the lot all need to be experienced visually before a buyer will drive to Walnut Creek for a showing. A full Matterport 3D walkthrough gives out-of-area and time-constrained buyers the ability to tour this home on their own terms, from anywhere, at any hour, and arrive at the showing already emotionally invested rather than still evaluating.

Pillar III - Find the Buyers Who Are Ready for Exactly This Home

The buyer most likely to pay a premium for a turnkey, no-surprises renovation in West Walnut Creek is probably not searching the local MLS right now. They are researching the Lamorinda and Diablo Valley corridor from San Francisco or Oakland, comparing neighborhoods, and waiting for something that removes the renovation risk they've seen in everything else. BrightWork's geo-targeted digital campaigns put 2660 Ross Place directly in front of that audience while they are still in research mode, before they've settled on a competing neighborhood or a competing listing.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

BrightWork Realty Advocates is a licensed real estate team operated by Ben Olsen, REALTOR, California DRE License #01409268. This communication is not intended to solicit properties currently listed for sale or under active representation.

The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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THE BRIGHTWORK ADVANTAGE

- Buy Before You Sell
- BrightFlip Pre-Sale Improvements
- Final Offer Platform
- Zillow Showcase + homes.com Premium
- Off-Market Network
- Built to Close Clean

YOUR LISTING ADVISOR

Ben Olsen

Founding Partner | REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates · DRE# 02014153

Ben founded BrightWork on a specific premise: the best outcomes are built before a home ever lists. With twenty years serving the East Bay's most competitive submarkets, he's developed a clear point of view on what separates a sale that closes well from one that doesn't, and the preparation, marketing, and negotiation strategy to act on it.

He entered the workforce at 14 in construction, a background that shapes how he thinks about pre-sale decisions, disclosure strategy, and what buyers actually scrutinize at inspection. That's a different lens than most agents carry into a listing consultation.

His approach to marketing is built on the same logic. Every campaign is designed for your home's specific buyer, not the average buyer. Portal strategy, campaign integration, and buyer targeting aren't add-ons at BrightWork. They're the baseline. Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure before the home lists. The preparation is the negotiation.

20+

YEARS SERVING
LAMORINDA

\$1B+

PROPERTIES
SOLD

1,000+

BUYERS &
SELLERS

WHY HE SENT YOU THIS PACKET

When a listing expires, Ben reviews it. Not to pitch you, but because after enough of them, the pattern of what goes wrong becomes clear. If you received this analysis, he looked at your specific property and has a specific point of view about what happened. That's the conversation he's offering. No listing agreement on the table. Just a review. He'll also walk you through programs that turn seller constraints into options, and show you what a transaction designed to get everyone to the closing table feeling good actually looks like.

Why BrightWork Realty Advocates

Rooted in Lamorinda since 1977. BrightWork is built on the premise that the best outcomes start before a home ever lists. An orchestrated campaign designed for your home's buyer, not the average buyer. Programs that turn seller constraints into options. Transactions designed so everyone gets to the closing table feeling good.

That's The Smart Way to Real Estate.

EIGHT REASONS SMART SELLERS CHOOSE BRIGHTWORK

01 Superior Presentation

Professional photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not the luxury package. The baseline.

02 Premium Portal Presence

Zillow Showcase and premium homes.com membership. Higher view counts, better placement, and buyer inquiries that route to your listing team.

03 Integrated Campaigns

Every sign, mailer, and open house connects to a digital system. Curious neighbors become trackable leads.

04 Modern Offer Management

Real-time portal data guides pricing decisions. Final Offer platform for properties with strong multi-offer potential.

05 Financial Tools & Capital Programs

Capital to fund pre-sale improvements with no out-of-pocket cost until close. Plus programs that remove the timing trap entirely.

06 Off-Market Strategy

A private list of serious Bay Area buyers. Test demand quietly or gain early access before properties hit MLS.

07 Advocacy for Unsold Homes

When a home hasn't sold, we don't re-list at a lower price. We conduct a forensic review and relaunch with a rebuilt strategy.

08 Built to Close Clean

Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure to every buyer before the house lists. He structures listings to attract the best first offers from a position no one can argue with. The preparation is the negotiation.

BrightWork has served Lamorinda since 1977. Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

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Not Every Home Needs a Public Launch.

For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or a different kind of timing — BrightWork has a smarter first step.

Most agents know one approach: list on the MLS, hit the portals, hold open houses. That works for many homes. For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or more control over timing, BrightWork offers a structured, documented private path to the right buyer — built on relationships in Lamorinda that go back to 1977.

OFF MARKET SELLING HAS ITS BENEFITS

Your Home, Your Timing, No Pressure

No days-on-market counter. No public record. No nosy neighbors. Your home stays entirely private until you choose otherwise, and if you do go public later, you start fresh, with a clean slate and zero wasted days behind you.

Buyers Who Are Actually Ready

BrightWork maintains a curated list of serious, pre-qualified Bay Area buyers who have asked to be notified about Lamorinda properties. They are not browsing Zillow. Every showing is by appointment, with someone who qualifies and is genuinely interested.

Real Feedback Before You Commit

An off-market phase gives you genuine buyer response before you decide whether to close privately or step into a full MLS campaign. Either way, you move forward with real data and momentum, not day-one guesswork.

BrightWork's network of private buyers and collaborative realtor relationships has served Lamorinda since 1977.

Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Deep relationships in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda.

WHO THE PRIVATE PATH SERVES

The Privacy-First Seller

No public listings, no open houses, and no days-on-market counter visible to buyers and agents, for whatever reason, professional or personal.

The Seller Still Preparing

Test genuine demand while staging or repairs are still underway, without burning days on market before you are ready.

The Strategically Timed Seller

Your next move depends on how this one closes. Control the sequence rather than react to a public countdown clock.

The Seller Testing the Waters

Get real buyer feedback before committing to a full public launch — or decide you do not need one at all.

Your home. Your timeline. Your terms.

Ready to find out whether the private path is the right first step?

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